

tors, PC cases, and cooling fans can often be found at a fraction of their original price and have a long lifespan. Always check their condition and compatibility.

Additional Tips

- **Power Supply:** Choose a reliable power supply unit (PSU) with at least an 80 Plus Bronze certification. A 450W PSU is typically sufficient.
- **Cooling:** Stock coolers that come with the CPU are generally adequate. If you plan to overclock or want quieter operation, consider an aftermarket cooler.
- **Peripherals:** Look for budget-friendly options from brands like Logitech and Redragon.

MID-RANGE (₹60K TO ₹120K)

A mid-range PC build strikes a balance between performance and cost, making it ideal for gamers and content creators who require more power than an entry-level build can provide.

1. Processor and GPU

Mid-range CPUs like the AMD Ryzen 5 or Intel Core i5 paired with an NVIDIA RTX 3050 or RTX 4060 or AMD RX 7600 offer excellent performance for most tasks and games. Make sure to leverage technologies such as DLSS and FSR wherever possible. When selecting these components, check benchmarks and reviews to ensure that they complement each other well.

2. Power Supply

Avoid overestimating your power supply needs. Use an online tool such as OuterVision Power Supply Calculator to determine the requirements and choose a PSU with a 50-100 watts buffer. This ensures stability and allows for some future upgrades. A PSU with a higher efficiency rating (80 Plus Gold or Platinum) is also recommended.

3. Peripherals

A decent keyboard and mouse need not be expensive. Prioritise functionality and ergonomics over aesthetics. Mechanical keyboards, for instance, are highly valued for their durability and typing experience, and you can find budget-friendly options from brands like Corsair and Cooler Master.

4. Aesthetics and RGB

Aesthetics and RGB should be low on your priority list. If aesthetics are important to you, there are budget-friendly options that do not compromise on performance, such as RGB fans and LED strips.

5. Immersion Enhancements

Invest in a good pair of headphones and a quality mouse pad to improve your overall experience. For headphones, brands like HyperX and Logitech offer excellent sound quality and comfort at reasonable prices. Also, a large mouse pad can provide ample space for smooth mouse movements.

Additional Tips

- **Motherboard:** Choose a motherboard with ample connectivity options for future score of expansion.
- **Storage:** Consider a combination of NVMe SSD for the OS and frequently used applications, and a larger HDD for additional storage. If you can get SSDs for cheaper, ditch hard drives altogether.
- **Cooling:** Mid-range builds benefit from improved cooling solutions. Consider tower air coolers or entry-level AIOs.

HIGH-END (OVER ₹120K)

A high-end PC build is for enthusiasts and professionals who demand the best performance for a variety of tasks.

1. Graphics Card

One high-end graphics card is typically sufficient. Technologies like SLI and CrossFire are no longer a thing. Only folks building a rig for render workloads will benefit from a multi-GPU setup. High-end GPUs like the NVIDIA RTX 4080 or 3080 or AMD Radeon RX 7900 XT or 6800 XT deliver exceptional performance. Some cutting edge features are also locked to the latest GPUs from NVIDIA. AMD, on the other hand, doesn't do that.

2. Processor

Research and benchmarks will help you find the best processor for your needs. For content creators, the AMD Ryzen 9 or Intel Core i9 are recommend. Some of the recent top-tier processors have stability issues that haven't been resolved for months now. So read up about those.

3. Cooling Solutions

Water cooling AIOs (All-in-One) aren't always superior to high-end air coolers. Consider the cooling performance, noise levels, and space requirements when choosing your cooling solution. Custom loop liquid cooling requires more maintenance and a higher budget, and is an option for enthusiasts.

4. Memory and Storage

Opt for a good stable kit of DDR5 RAM (5200MT/s or higher) and ensure you have enough capacity for your needs. In a high-end build, 32 GB of RAM is recommended. For storage, consider a combination of multiple NVMe SSDs for speed and HDDs for additional capacity. Using multiple NVMe SSDs can further enhance system performance. Remember, you can't fill every slot. Read the user manual of the motherboard to see how the PCIe lanes are shared between slots.

5. Case and Build Quality

Invest in a high-quality case with good airflow, space, and build quality. Features like tempered glass panels, cable management options, and dust filters can enhance the the longevity of your components. High-end cases from brands like Cooler Master, Fractal Design, NZXT, and Corsair offer excellent build quality, aesthetics, and functionality.

6. Monitor

Opt for a decent monitor that is about 24-27 inches and has a refresh rate of at least 144 Hz. You would want high FPS at 2K in first person shooter titles or moderate FPS at 4K in an action-adventure game. The panel type can be IPS or VA or TN. Specialised FPS monitors will still have TN panels, especially the ones which go up to 360 Hz or higher. For most, an IPS panel is enough. Top gaming monitors at the moment are all based on QD-OLED panels. So depending on your budget, pick the panel that gives you the best experience.

7. PSU and Networking

Choose a high-wattage (~750 W), high efficiency power supply (80 Plus Gold or Platinum) to ensure stability and support for future. If you require fast and reliable internet connectivity, consider a motherboard with built-in Wi-Fi 6. **d**